Visual Identity & System Guidelines

Keizersgracht Media | Version 1.0

BROADSHEET REFERENCE
A3 LANDSCAPE • 420 × 297mm
DIGITAL & PHYSICAL SPECIFICATION

00 GUIDING PRINCIPLE

These guidelines are a compass, not a rulebook. We build software, AI agents, and data tools around how teams actually work. Our visual identity reflects that: grounded, unpretentious, and human. Whether designing a website, an internal tool, or physical collateral, keep it clear, tactile, and free of agency fluff.

01 BRAND AND VOICE

- **Two senior operators.** Direct communication and real flexibility. No account managers, no six-month slide-deck phases, no corporate overhead.
- **Speak like a person.** Be direct, warm, and conversational. Write like you speak over coffee.
- **Active outcomes.** Lead with what the software accomplishes (*"Turning incoming messages into ready-to-send replies"*). Avoid speculative tech jargon.
- **No synthetic hype.** Ban fake percentage badges ("+340% ROI"), made-up latency counters, and synthetic ISO badges. Real utility needs no hype.
- **Human in the loop.** When presenting automation, always show the human review, verification, and approval step before action executes.

The sweet spot

Replace inflated marketing claims with simple, grounded sentences:

- *"Software that organizes incoming orders and drafts replies."* (Not: "Enterprise cognitive AI synergy platform").
- *"Tools built around the way your team actually works."* (Not: "Revolutionizing human workflows via neural pipelines").

Visual anti-patterns

- **No generic AI tropes.** Never use glowing neon orbs, floating plastic cubes, or purple/indigo gradients.
- **No cartoon people.** Show human teams through the tools they use or the data they inspect.
- **No bloated bentos.** Avoid decorative card mosaics packed with meaningless icon filler; let actual tasks dictate layout.

02 TYPOGRAPHY AND HIERARCHY

A clear three-tier system: geometric Dutch humanist display for structure, neutral geometric sans for reading, and crisp monospace for technical values.

- **Display — Sintony Bold (700):** Architectural geometric sans with Dutch humanist weight. Reserved for hero statements, H1/H2 titles, and focal numbers.
- **Body & UI — Poppins (400, 500, 600):** Open geometric sans with high legibility across screens and print. Regular for body, Medium for subtitles, SemiBold for UI controls.
- **Metadata — JetBrains Mono (500):** Crisp monospace for technical tags, hex values, tracking stats, and micro-labels.

Typescale reference

ROLE	SIZE / LEADING	SAMPLE
Hero	`80px / 1.08`	Light work.
H1 Title	`38px / 1.12`	Turning incoming messages.
H2 Subtitle	`20px / 1.45`	Software built around your team.
Body	`14px / 1.70`	AI and software that fit how you operate.
Eyebrow	`11px / +0.14em`	01 — WORKFLOW AUTOMATION
Metadata	`10.5px / Mono`	`STATUS: 200 OK · RUN_ID: #885b1d81`

Typesetting rules

- **Sentence case:** Use natural sentence case for all headlines, subheads, and buttons. Avoid aggressive Title Casing.
- **Tracked caps:** Eyebrows and micro-tags always use uppercase with tracking set between `+0.12em` and `+0.18em`.
- **Tabular numbers:** In UI dashboards, tables, and metric displays, always enable `font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums`.
- **Line measure:** Keep running editorial text between 45 and 70 characters per line for comfortable cadence.
- **Container breathing room:** Never squeeze text against borders. Always size cards with enough vertical padding so trailing lines sit naturally.

03 COLOR TOKENS AND SURFACES

Six foundational tokens rooted in warm mineral materials. Canvas replaces sterile white with the tactile quality of uncoated paper.

TOKEN	HEX	USED FOR
Canvas	`#F5F4ED`	Page background, primary substrate, card fill
Sand	`#ECE8E1`	Secondary cards, founder surfaces, warm neutral
Espresso	`#351E1C`	Titles (Sintony Bold), main body text, active borders
Terracotta	`#733635`	Subtitles, captions, metadata, hairline dividers
Coral	`#FF6037`	Primary action buttons, active pins, focal emphasis
Aqua	`#A0C9CB`	Data pathways, water vectors, secondary tool accents

Atmospheric washes (live site)

Grounded horizontal mineral washes used across case study sections:

01 Soft Coral (Workflow & Process)	`#F5F4ED → #F9BCA8 → #ECE8E1`
02 Mineral Aqua (Clean Water Agency)	`#F5F4ED → #C2DAD9 → #ECE8E1`
03 Limestone Wash (Pricing Tool)	`#F5F4ED → #D7C8C3 → #ECE8E1`

Material honesty & print stock

- **Digital interfaces:** Should feel like heavyweight matte paper, not glossy plastic. Avoid synthetic glassmorphism and specular glows.
- **Print collateral:** In stationery, cards, and packaging, specify 450–600gsm uncoated warm cotton stock (FSC-certified). Blind deboss or spot terracotta ink.
- **Contrast:** Espresso on Canvas achieves 14.2:1 (AAA). Terracotta on Canvas achieves 7.1:1 (AAA). Coral is reserved for interactive actions.

04 CORNER RADII AND SYSTEM

We reject rounded-full pill shapes and generic 20px bubble cards. Keizersgracht relies on an architectural micro-radius:

✓ APPROVED SPEC
2px – 3px radius
Architectural micro-chamfer

✕ FORBIDDEN
16px+ / Pill radius
Generic SaaS bubble shape

- **Cards:** `3px` radius, with a warm shadow: `0 10px 24px rgba(115, 54, 53, 0.08)`.
- **Checkboxes, buttons, controls:** `2px` radius.
- **Skeleton and chart bars:** `1px` radius.
- **Never use fully rounded pill shapes.**

Spatial 8-point rhythm

All layout margins, card padding, and flex gaps derive strictly from multiples of 8px (`8, 16, 24, 32, 48, 64px`).

Action button (2px radius) — GRAB A COFFEE →

Photography & visual media

- **Documentary realism:** Real founders, physical team spaces, and operational workflows only. Strict rectangular crops with zero rounded corners and zero vignette fade.
- **Warm mineral grade:** Layered with a 3% warm Coral tint (`rgba(255, 96, 55, 0.03)`) and a hairline border (`rgba(53, 30, 28, 0.08)`).

Universal collateral rules

- **Cross-media consistency:** Whether designing an internal dashboard, client portal, or physical letterhead, adhere to the 3px micro-chamfer and 8px rhythm.
- **Less, but tactile:** White space is functional breathing room, not empty void. Let content sit comfortably on the canvas.